



VERBS

The words that show action or being

1 What is it?

Verbs (vurbz)

A verb is a word that shows an action, a state of being, or an occurrence. Every complete sentence needs at least one verb.

doing word OR being word

2 See it in action

Action

"She **ran** to the shop and **bought** some milk."

Being

"He **is** tired, and she **seems** happy."

Occurring

"The storm **arrived** quickly, and the lights **flickered**."

Thinking/feeling

"I **believe** you, and I **hope** it works out."



Think about...

Try reading a sentence without its verb — you'll notice immediately that nothing is actually happening.

3 More to know

Future

"She **will finish** the project by Friday."

Modal

"You **must** remember your book; you **should** also bring a pen."

FUN FACT

"Go" has one of the most irregular verb histories in English — its past tense "went" actually comes from a completely different old word, "wend", not from "go" at all.

4 Why it's used

Verbs help: drive every sentence forward — they tell the reader what's happening, who's doing it, and when (past, present or future).

Verbs change form depending on tense (walk / walked / will walk) and can be regular (add -ed) or irregular (go / went, not 'goed').



Look here!

If a word can change to show past, present or future (walk/walked/will walk), it's a verb.

5 Where you'll spot it

Action verbs

Show something physically or mentally happening: run, think, decide, laugh.

Being/linking verbs

Connect the subject to more information rather than showing action: is, seem, become, appear.

⚠ Watch out!

A word that looks like a verb isn't always acting as one — in "the running water", running is describing water (acting like an adjective), not being the main verb of the sentence.

6 Quick recap

Shows action or being

Every sentence needs one

Changes with tense



Good spot!

Watch for irregular verbs like 'go/went' and 'see/saw' — they don't follow the normal -ed pattern.